example, the .NET 7 SDK can also build .NET 6 apps, .NET 5 apps, .NET Core 3.1 apps, and so on. By contrast, the .NET 6 SDK can't build .NET 7 applications.

TIP Some IDEs, such as Visual Studio, can automatically install .NET 7 as part of their installation process. There is no problem installing multiple versions of .NET side by side, so you can always install the .NET SDK manually, whether your IDE installs a different version or not.

By default, when you run `dotnet` commands from the command line, you'll be using the latest version of the .NET SDK you have installed. You can control that and use an older version of the SDK by adding a global.json file to the folder. For an introduction to this file, as well as details on how to use it and how to understand .NET's versioning system, see my blog entry "Exploring the new rollForward and allowPrerelease settings in global.json" at http://mng.bz/KMzP.

TIP If you run into any problems during the install process, the `dotnet` command isn't recognized, or you get an error when running the command, I suggest checking the installation documentation for troubleshooting tips: https://learn.microsoft.com/dotnet/core/install.

Once you have the .NET SDK installed, it's time to choose an IDE or editor. The choices available will depend on which operating system you're using and will largely be driven by personal preference.

A.2 Choosing an IDE or editor

In this section I'll describe a few of the most popular IDEs and editors for .NET development and how to install them. Choosing an IDE is a personal choice, so this section describes only a few of the options. If your favorite